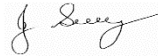


SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	FORKLIFT - SAFE OPERATION	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> Phone	<u></u> Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V11.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L Likely	M Moderate	U Unlikely
H (1) (High level of harm)	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) (High)	1	1	2
M (2) (Medium level of harm)	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) (Medium)	1	2	3
L (3) (Low level of harm)	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) (Low)	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training and skill	Un-trained persons could cause injury to themselves and others. Possible property damage.	1	1. All persons operating mobile plant or equipment must carry with them a current 'Construction Induction Card'. 2. All persons operating a forklift must be suitably licensed, trained and competent in the work they are to perform. 3. No person shall operate the forklift without a HIGH RISK FORKLIFT LICENCE.	Management	2
Work area	Persons not advised of forklift operation.	1	1. Prominently display warning signs such as; "CAUTION- FORKLIFT OPERATING ON SITE".	Manager	2
Pre-start	Brake failure Warning devices not working.	1	1. Completing the safety checklist should be part of every forklift operator's daily routine. 2. Before starting shift all operators should check their forklift is in safe working order, ready to be used and capable of completing the tasks required of it. 3. Ensure forklift warning devices and flashing lights are functioning at all times. 4. If any damage or problems with a forklift are noticed, they should immediately. 5. Before starting your forklift, familiarise yourself with the area in which you will be driving. 6. Before starting the forklift always check that ground surfaces are even and clear of obstructions. 7. If you observe any hazards that may impact on the safe operation of a forklift notify your supervisor. 8. Take the time to walk around, assess the site and ensure the following is satisfactory.	Operator	2
Forklift operation	Striking personnel with forklift.	1	1. No person shall operate a forklift unless they are trained & competent to do so. Trained and assessed in the safe operation and health & safety procedures. 2. The forklift is to operate within a designated area, separate from pedestrians. 3. Slowing down and sounding your horn as you approach a corner is a good, safe practice. 4. Passengers on forklifts are strictly forbidden, unless there is a separate seat provided with a restraint. 5. All persons are to be kept clear when forklift is in operation. 6. The operator to take care when moving between artificial and natural light. 7. Forklift is to driven at all times with forks lowered.	Manager Supervisor Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Forklift tipping over & overturning	1	1. Ramps are not to be used unless the forklift operator is trained in their use. 2. The operator is to remain seated and secure at all times. 3. The forklift is to be driven at a safe speed. 4. Turns are not to be taken sharply (a cornering forklift can overturn at 6km per/hr or less). 5. Do not turn on sloping ground. 6. Forklift is not to be driven with load raised. 7. Loads are <u>not to be</u> carried forwards down a slope. 8. Loads are to evenly balanced prior to moving. 9. Extra care is to be taken when working on uneven ground, sloping ground or traveling across an incline. 10. The operator is to remain in the cabin if the forklift overturns. (If the forklift overturns, the safest place for the operator is in the cabin, restrained by a seat-belt. The most common cause of death is when the operator attempts to jump clear of an overturning forklift and is crushed).	Operator	2
	Collision with other vehicles or objects.	1	1. The forklift is to be driven at a safe speed and within the designated areas. 2. Designated areas to be kept free of other vehicles and debris.	Operator	2
	Body protruding out and hitting an object	1	1. No part of the operator's body is to protrude beyond the overhead protection.	Operator	2
	Losing a load	1	1. Load is to be made secure and lowered to a safe centre of gravity before carrying. 2. Sudden stops and starts are to be avoided.	Operator	2
Storing of Forklift	Explosion	1	1. Forklifts powered by an LPG engine should be refueled, parked and stored in well-ventilated areas; and a safe distance from combustible material, sources of heat and adequately ventilated areas.	Operator	2
Gas refueling	Explosion	1	Gas cylinder removal and replacement: 1. Only persons who have received relevant training should remove empty LPG cylinders from forklifts and install full LPG cylinders. 2. Removal and replacement should be in accordance with the relevant standards. 3. Cylinders should be positioned so that the safety relief valve is in direct communication with the vapour space of the cylinder at all times, so that if the relief valve operates it will release vapour and not liquid. 4. The cylinder valve should be turned off when the forklift is not in use.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Battery Charging and Changing	Electrocution Explosion	1	Battery Charging and Changing - Only persons who have received relevant training should be permitted to charge and change batteries on forklifts. Appropriate personal protective equipment such as face shields, aprons and rubber gloves must be used, to prevent eye or skin injury from battery acid. - The forklift should be parked in a safe position and the parking brake applied before battery-charging operations begin. Operators should ensure the vent caps in the batteries are functioning correctly and remain in place during charging to prevent electrolyte spraying. - Safety precautions to be observed by all persons involved in a battery charging operation include: - No smoking; No open flames; - No use of metal objects that might strike a spark near battery cells; - Proper tools provided and used; - Eyes protected; and Rings and bracelets removed. - In areas where batteries are charged or changed it is important that washing facilities (including those for eye washing) for removing acid spills or splashes are provided. If acid is spilled it should be diluted with large quantities of water. If workers are splashed with battery acid they should quickly remove contaminated clothing and flush skin with large quantities of water. - Adequate fire extinguishers must be provided. - In addition, adequate ventilation is necessary to ensure gases generated during battery charging are dispersed.	Operator	2
Additional safety measures	Injury to personnel	1	- When getting off a forklift ensure the parking brake is set, the forks are lowered and controls are neutralised. - Forklifts are designed to lift and move loads, not people. Raising people on forks or pallets is extremely risky and is a prohibited work practice. - When leaving a forklift unattended, always lower the forks, apply the park brake, close the gas cylinder valve and remove the ignition key.	Operator	2

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	
Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.						
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)		Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required		Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training		Fire Extinguisher training		Fatigue Management Training	
A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.						
Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)						
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022						
Codes of Practice						
Confined Spaces – 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020		Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018		
Construction Work – 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020		Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019		
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020		WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018		
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018		Safe Design of Structures - 2018		
Plant & Equipment for this activity						
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.						
List of plant for this Activity						
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):						

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.